

Dake Bu

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Large Language Model; Diffusion Model; Deep Learning Theory; Distribution Optimization; Reinforcement Learning; Non-log Concave Sampling; Mean-Field Optimization

WORK EXPERIENCES

Centre for Frontier AI and Research, A*STAR, Research Intern

Dec. 2025 – Present

- Working on theory and application of sampling and distribution optimization in deep learning. PI: [Atsushi Nitanda](#).

School of Mathematics and Statistics, University of Sydney, Visiting Student

May. 2026 – Jun. 2026

- Working on theory and application of Discrete Diffusion Model. PI: [Andi Han](#).

RIKEN Center for Advanced Intelligence Project, Research Intern

Dec. 2024 – Oct. 2025

- Working on theoretically-grounded deep learning methods as a member of Deep Learning Theory Team. PI: [Taiji Suzuki](#).

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

Department of Computer Science, City University of Hong Kong (CityUHK)

Oct. 2023 – Present

Ph.D. | GPA: 3.92/4.0

Major: Computer Science | Supervisors: [Hau-san Wong](#), [Qingfu Zhang](#)

Hong Kong SAR

School of Mathematics and Statistics, Xi'an Jiaotong University (XJTU)

Aug. 2019 – Jun. 2023

B.Sc. | GPA: 86.62/100

Major: Information and Computational Science | Supervisors: [Hui Li](#), [Jian Sun](#)

Xi'an, Shaanxi, PRC

RESEARCH OUTPUTS

- Dake Bu**, Atsushi Nitanda, Tanya Veeravalli, Hau-San Wong, Qingfu Zhang and Taiji Suzuki. Polynomial Convergence of Riemannian Mean-Field Langevin Dynamics: A Case Study on Single Index Model. (In Submission)
- Atsushi Nitanda, **Dake Bu**, Yueming Lyu, Tanya Veeravalli. Slowly Annealed Langevin Dynamics: Theory and Applications to Training-Free Guided Generation. (In Submission)
- Dake Bu**, Wei Huang, Andi Han, Atsushi Nitanda, Qingfu Zhang, Hau-San Wong, and Taiji Suzuki. Provable Sample Efficiency of Curriculum Post-Training for Transformer Reasoning (**ICML 2026**).
- Dake Bu**, Wei Huang, Andi Han, Hau-San Wong, Qingfu Zhang, Taiji Suzuki, and Atsushi Nitanda. DPRM: A Plug-in Doob h transform-induced Token-Ordering Module for Diffusion Language Models (**ICML 2026 Fogen [Oral (top 5%)]**).

5. **Dake Bu**, Wei Huang, Andi Han, Atsushi Nitanda, Bo Xue, Qingfu Zhang, Hau-San Wong, and Taiji Suzuki. Distributional Biases in Post-Training: A Markovian Analysis of Reasoning Trajectories (**ICML 2026 Fogen [Spotlight (top 15%)]**).
6. **Dake Bu**, Wei Huang, Andi Han, Atsushi Nitanda, Qingfu Zhang, Hau-San Wong, and Taiji Suzuki. Provable In-Context Vector Arithmetic via Retrieving Task Concepts. The 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (**ICML 2025**).
7. Bo Xue, **Dake Bu**, Ji Cheng, Yuanyu Wan, Qingfu Zhang. Multi-objective Linear Reinforcement Learning with Lexicographic Rewards (**ICML 2025**).
8. **Dake Bu**, Wei Huang, Andi Han, Atsushi Nitanda, Taiji Suzuki, Qingfu Zhang, Hau-San Wong: Provably Transformers Harness Multi-Concept Word Semantics for Efficient In-Context Learning (**NeurIPS 2024**).
9. **Dake Bu**, Wei Huang, Taiji Suzuki, Ji Cheng, Qingfu Zhang, Zhiqiang Xu, Hau-San Wong: Provably Neural Active Learning Succeeds via Prioritizing Perplexing Samples (**ICML 2024**).

HONORARY AWARDS

- Gold Reviewer Award - Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning 2026
- Research Tuition Scholarship - CityUHK (Top 5%) 2024-2025
- Outstanding Academic Performance Award for Research Degree Students - CityUHK (Top 10%) 2023-2024
- Postgraduate Studentship - Hong Kong Government (for excellent non-local student) 2023-2025
- Advanced Individual - XJTU (Top 1%) 2021-2022
- School-level Scholarship - XJTU (Top 15%) 2020-2022
- Merit Student - XJTU (Top 20%) 2019-2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

CS3483 Multimodal Interface Design , Teaching Assistant	2024/25 Semester B; 2023/24 Semester B
Held tutorials and graded assignments.	
CS3481 Fundamentals of Data Science , Teaching Assistant	2025/26 Semester A; 024/25 Semester A
Held tutorials and graded assignments.	

SERVICES

Area Chair ,
ICML 2026 FOGEN; ICLR 2026 DeLTa
Reviewer ,
ICML (2024; 2025; 2026); NeurIPS (2024; 2025; 2026); ICLR (2025; 2026)

SKILLS & ABILITIES

Software Skills: MATLAB, Latex (Tex studio), Pytorch, Microsoft office & WPS, Power Point, Pycharm, Photo Shop, Excel

Programming Skills: Python, Java, C, C++, SQL, HTML, JavaScript, MATLAB.

Language: English: Fluent (TOEFL 109), Japanese: Basic, Mandarin: Native.

Art Skills: Brush Calligraphy (Amateur level 8), Guitar, Board Painting